

Fostering Commitment and Ownership

Chapter 5 — Sustaining Change

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Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will be able to:

- **Distinguish** between compliance and commitment in the context of change.
- **Analyze** the "Ladder of Commitment" model.
- **Evaluate** the psychological state of "Ownership" (this is mine).
- **Apply** strategies to foster employee engagement during transitions.
- **Understand** the role of communication and trust in building commitment.

Compliance vs. Commitment

Successful change requires more than just obedience.

Compliance ("Have to")

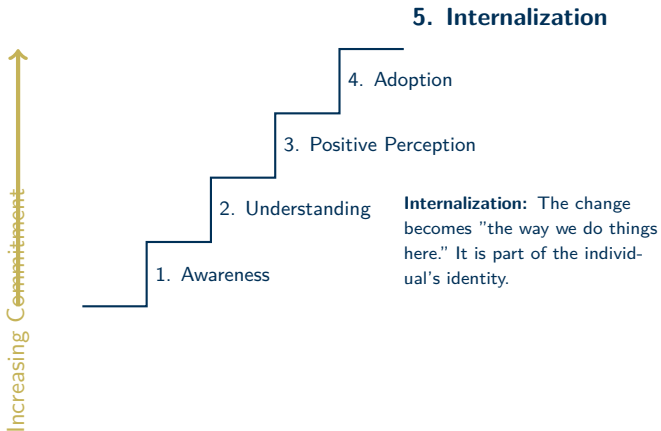
- Driven by external force (rules, authority).
- Outcome: Employees do the bare minimum to avoid punishment.
- Sustainable only with constant supervision.

Commitment ("Want to")

- Driven by internal belief (values, buy-in).
- Outcome: Employees go "above and beyond" (Discretionary Effort).
- Self-sustaining.

The Ladder of Commitment

Commitment is not a switch; it is a journey.



Factors Influencing Commitment

Why do some commit while others disengage?

Drivers of Commitment



Managerial Action: We cannot change personal factors easily, but we can shape the organizational context.

Engagement acts as the engine for commitment.

Definition

A positive, fulfilling, work-related state of mind characterized by vigor, dedication, and absorption. (Schaufeli et al.)

Engagement Drivers during Change:

- **Meaningfulness:** Understanding *why* the change matters.
- **Safety:** Feeling safe to express opinions without retribution.
- **Availability:** Having the physical and emotional resources to cope.

The feeling that the organization (or the change initiative) is "Mine."

Routes to Ownership (Pierce et al.)

How do we create this feeling?

1. **Control:** Letting employees influence the design of the change.
2. **Knowledge:** Giving employees deep understanding of the problem.
3. **Investment of Self:** Allowing employees to invest their time and energy (Sweat Equity).

Result: "This is OUR project," not "This is Management's project."

Communication: The Oxygen of Commitment

Commitment dies in a vacuum. Effective communication is:

- **Bidirectional:** Not just broadcasting (Push), but listening (Pull).
- **Timely:** Reduces the gap where rumors grow.
- **Honest:** Acknowledges the difficulties ("The Reality Principle").

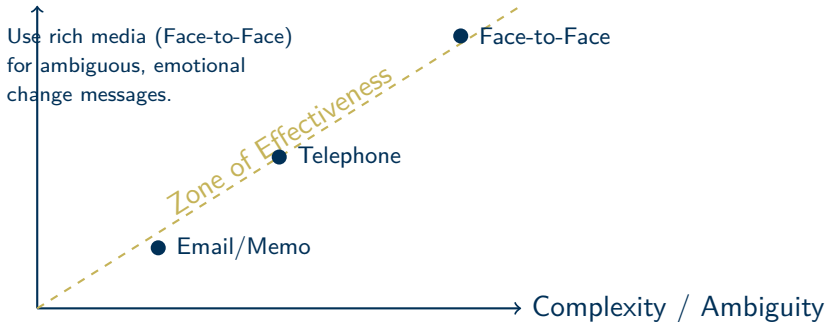
Sense-Giving

Communication is not just data transmission; it is shaping how people interpret reality (Sense-making).

Media Richness Theory (Daft & Lengel)

Choose the right channel for the complexity of the message.

Media Richness



Trust: The Foundation

You cannot have commitment without trust.

Types of Trust in Change:

- **Competence Trust:** Do I believe leaders know *how* to execute this change?
- **Contractual Trust:** Do leaders keep their promises?
- **Communication Trust:** Are leaders telling the truth?

Trust Asymmetry

Trust is slow to build (incremental) but fast to destroy (instant).

How to move people up the "Ladder of Commitment"?

1. **Participation:** Involve people early. "People support what they help create."
2. **Visioning:** Connect the change to the larger purpose.
3. **Quick Wins:** Demonstrate progress to build confidence.
4. **Support:** Provide training and emotional support to reduce anxiety.

Summary:

1. **Commitment** is superior to compliance for sustaining change.
2. **Psychological Ownership** ("This is mine") is achieved through control, knowledge, and self-investment.
3. Communication must be matched to the complexity of the message (Media Richness).
4. **Trust** is the glue that holds commitment together during the uncertainty of transition.

Thank You

Questions?